

LAURALES

The order Laurales consists of seven families of trees, shrubs, and woody climbing plants. A few genera grow in temperate parts of the world, but most are found in tropical and subtropical regions. Their classification is based on genetic analysis rather than morphological characteristics. Many plants are aromatic and are used in perfumery, cookery, and medicine. Others provide timber or are grown ornamentally.

BAY LAUREL

Laurus nobilis
F: Lauraceae

Widely cultivated for its aromatic leaves used in flavouring, this species grows in woods, scrub, and rocky habitats around the Mediterranean.



SASSAFRAS

Sassafras albidum
F: Lauraceae

This suckering deciduous tree of woodland in eastern N. America has aromatic leaves which are brightly coloured in autumn.



CINNAMON

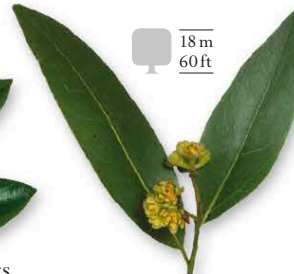
Cinnamomum verum
F: Lauraceae

The spice cinnamon comes from the aromatic bark of this species, found in lowland forests in Sri Lanka.

CAROLINA ALLSPICE

Calycanthus floridus
F: Calycanthaceae

Native to woods and streamsides in S.E. USA, Carolina allspice has aromatic leaves and bark and large, fragrant flowers.



CALIFORNIA LAUREL

Umbellularia californica
F: Lauraceae

Sometimes called "headache tree", as scent from the crushed leaves can cause headaches, this species from W. USA flowers in winter.



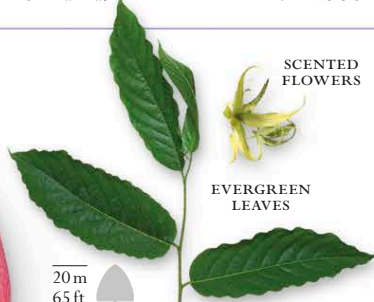
AVOCADO TREE

Persea americana
F: Lauraceae

Probably originating in S. Mexico, in well-drained parts of rainforests, the avocado tree is now widely cultivated for its edible pear-shaped fruits.



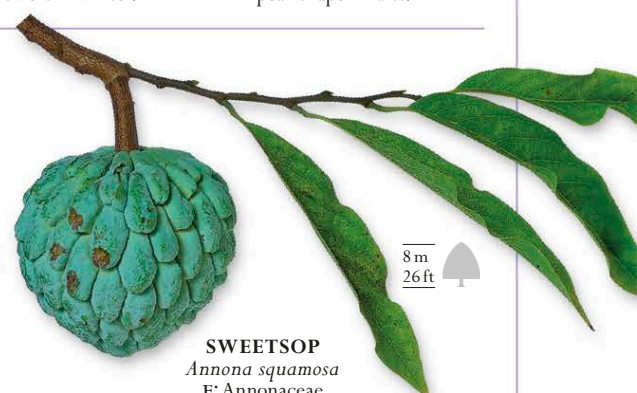
white to dark pink flowers open early in spring before the leaves



YLANG-YLANG

Cananga odorata
F: Annonaceae

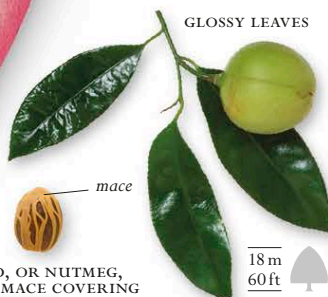
Oil from the fragrant flowers of ylang-ylang are used in perfumery. This evergreen tree comes from parts of Asia and Australia.



SWEETSOP

Annona squamosa
F: Annonaceae

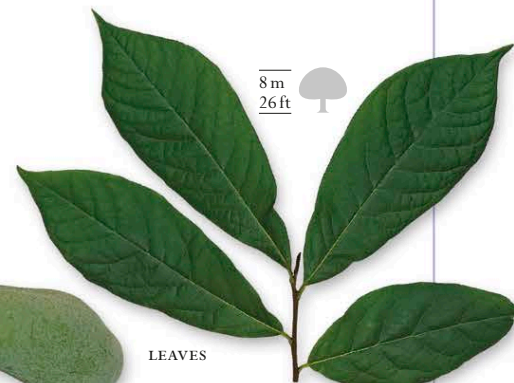
Believed to have Caribbean origins, sweetsop, or sugar or custard apple, is widely cultivated. The fruits have edible flesh, which look and taste like custard.



NUTMEG

Myristica fragrans
F: Myristicaceae

The spices nutmeg and mace are both obtained from the seeds of this evergreen tree, a native of the Molucca – or Spice – Islands of Indonesia.



PAWPAW

Asimina triloba
F: Annonaceae

This deciduous tree is native to damp woods of eastern N. America. Its singly borne flowers produce edible fruits.